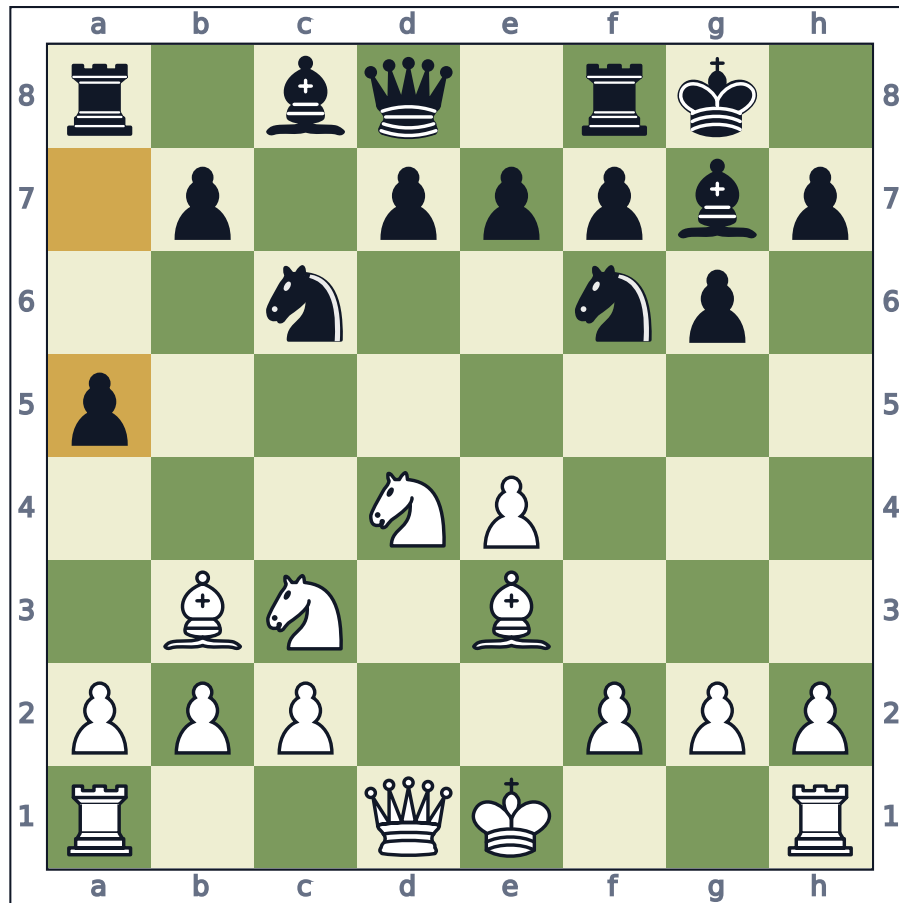


# Accelerated Dragon

A ground-up visual course for practical play



Core route position - gold marks the last move

BOTH SIDES

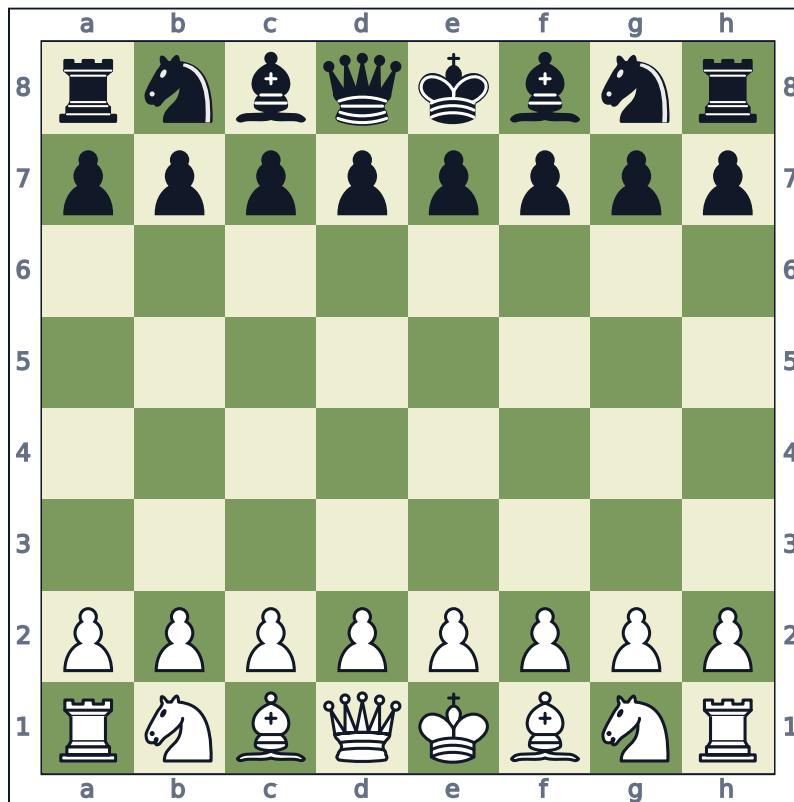
## OPENING IDENTITY

Black fianchettoes without ...d6, keeping the option of a one-move ...d5 break.

## ORIENTATION

# Ground zero: read the board and the moves

White starts from ranks 1-2; Black starts from ranks 7-8. Files run a through h. Each lesson highlights the last move in gold so your eyes connect notation to the board.



Starting position - White to move

## HOW ALGEBRAIC NOTATION WORKS

Nf3 means a knight moves to f3. B means bishop, R rook, Q queen, K king; pawns use only the destination square. An x means capture, + means check, and O-O means kingside castling.

## YOUR FIRST ANCHOR

Say the first moves aloud, then point to every destination square:

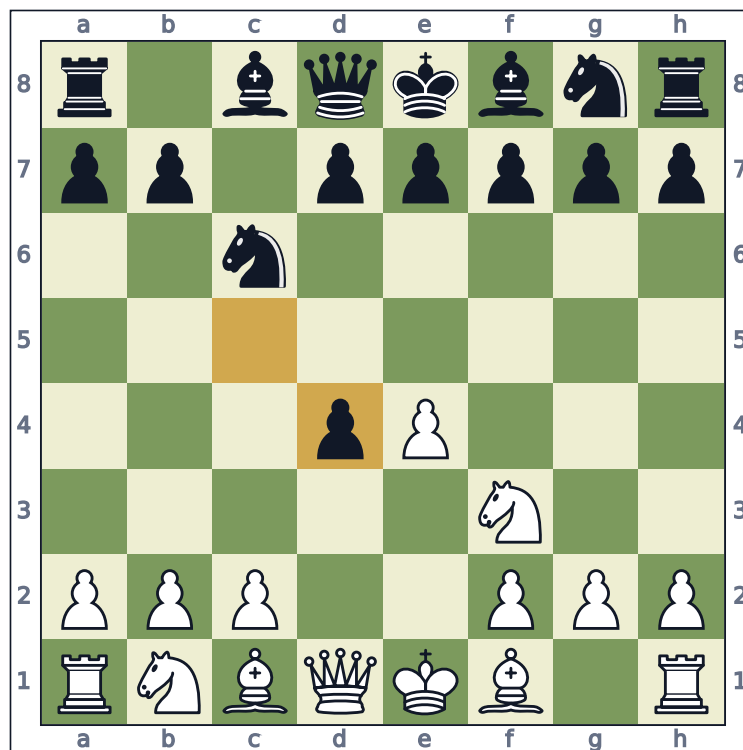
1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4

Course promise: No ...d6 means ...d5 is always in the room.

## MOVES 1-3

# Lesson 1: the first conversation

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4



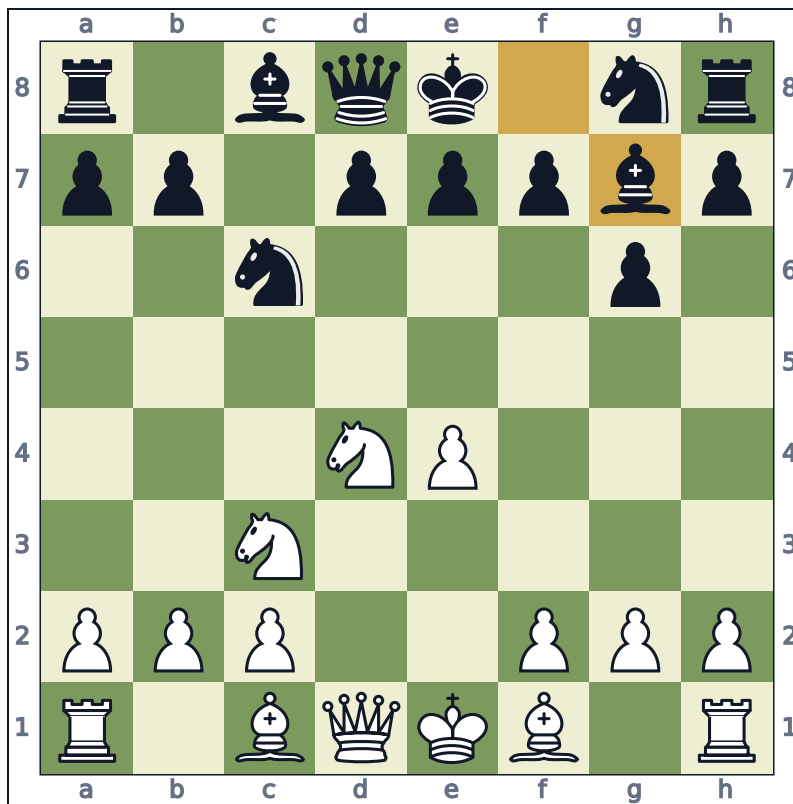
After 3. d4 cxd4

- 1. e4 - Claims or challenges central space and opens a line for a piece.
- 1... c5 - Creates a lever against the center or supports a coming break.
- 2. Nf3 - Develops a knight toward the center and increases control of key central squares.
- 2... Nc6 - Develops a knight toward the center and increases control of key central squares.
- 3. d4 - Claims or challenges central space and opens a line for a piece.
- 3... cxd4 - Resolves central tension and changes the pawn structure.

## DEVELOPMENT

# Lesson 2: build the core position

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. Nc3 Bg7

**WHAT THE PIECES ARE BUILDING**

Black fianchettoes without ...d6, keeping the option of a one-move ...d5 break.

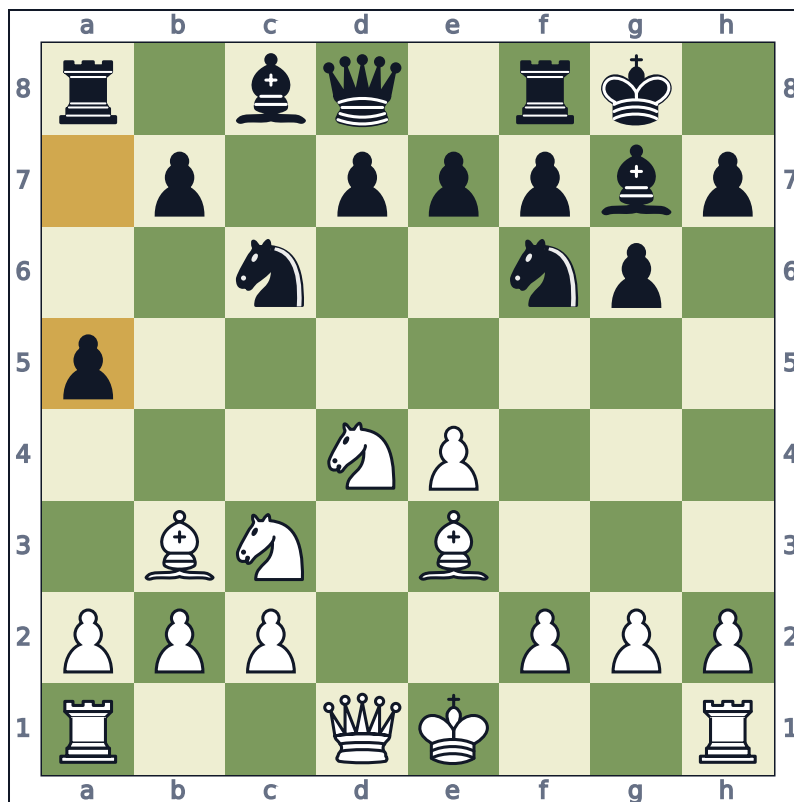
**BEGINNER CHECKPOINT**

Before copying the next move, ask: Is my king safe? Which piece is still at home? What changed in the center? Which pawn break is each side preparing?

## CORE LINE

# Lesson 3: complete the main route

1. e4 c5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. d4 cxd4 4. Nxd4 g6 5. Nc3 Bg7 6. Be3 Nf6 7. Bc4 O-O 8. Bb3 a5



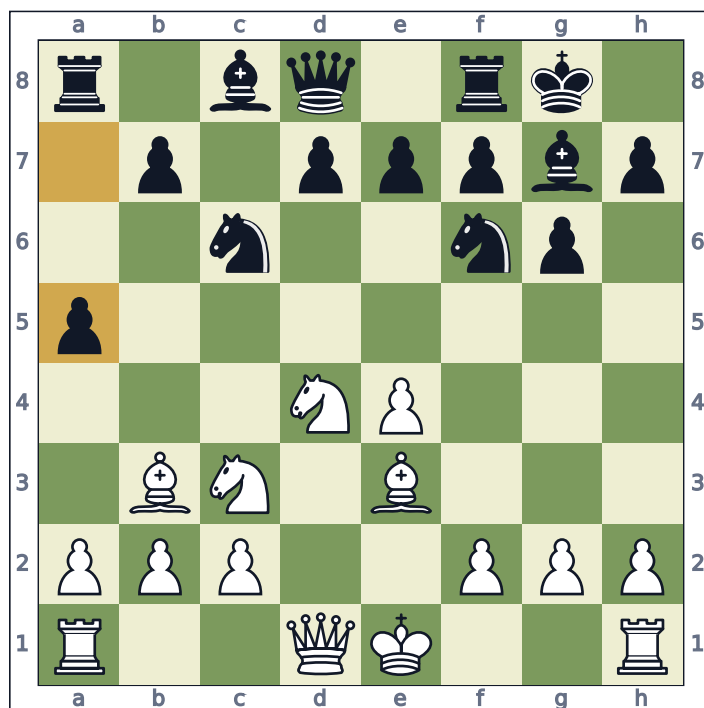
*Core position - now plans matter more than memorized moves*

## DO NOT MEMORIZE BLINDLY

The route is a model, not a forced script. Its job is to teach this relationship: Black fianchettoes without ...d6, keeping the option of a one-move ...d5 break. If the opponent deviates, preserve the same priorities until a concrete tactic changes them.

## UNDERSTANDING

# The position map: plans for both sides



*Read plans from the pawn structure, not from the opening name*

**WHITE'S PLAN**

Control d5, consider the Maroczy structure with c4, and avoid routine attacking moves.

**BLACK'S PLAN**

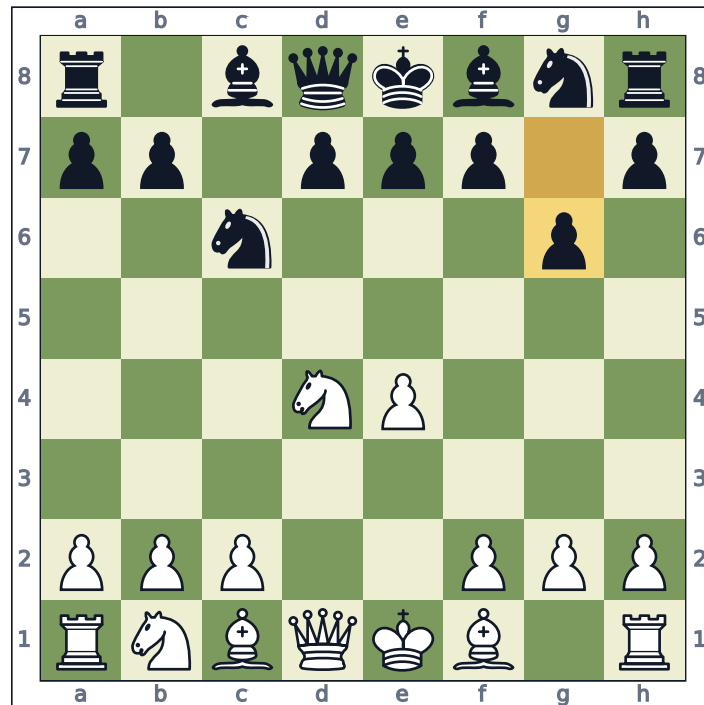
Use rapid activity, pressure d4, and strike with ...d5 when tactically sound.

**THE LEVER TO REMEMBER**

...d5 is the opening's central question; White's c4 can restrain it.

## CALCULATION

# Tactical literacy: what can suddenly change



Pause here - White to move

**THEME**

Tactics on d4 and c3 appear when White's center is underdefended.

**COMMON BEGINNER ERROR**

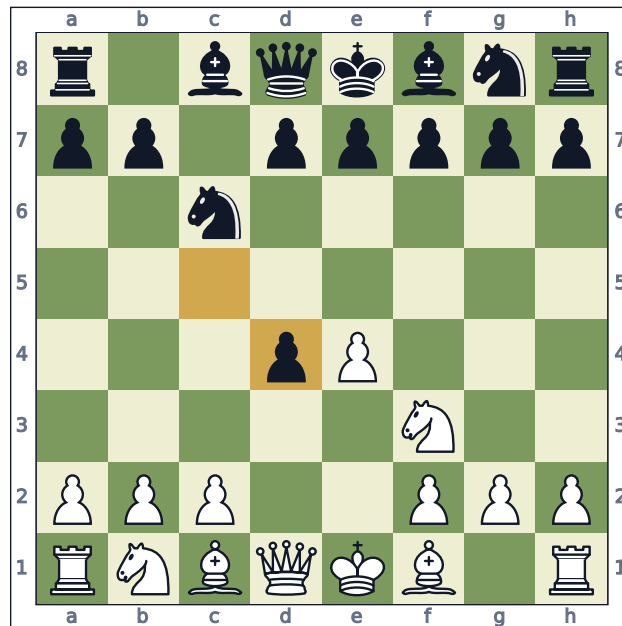
Playing as if this were a regular Dragon and allowing ...d5 in one move.

**THREE-SECOND SAFETY SCAN**

1. Checks against both kings. 2. Captures in the center. 3. Threats against loose or pinned pieces.

## ADAPTATION

# Decision tree: when the opponent leaves the route



*A branch point - principles are your map*

## 1. If the center stays fluid

Finish development and keep the opening identity in view: Black fianchettoes without ...d6, keeping the option of a one-move ...d5 break.

## 2. If the center closes

Use the pawn-chain direction. Attack the base before making wing moves that cannot be supported.

## 3. If the center opens

Prioritize king safety, active pieces, and checks or captures before slow pawn moves.

## 4. If nothing is forced

Return to the planned lever: ...d5 is the opening's central question; White's c4 can restrain it.

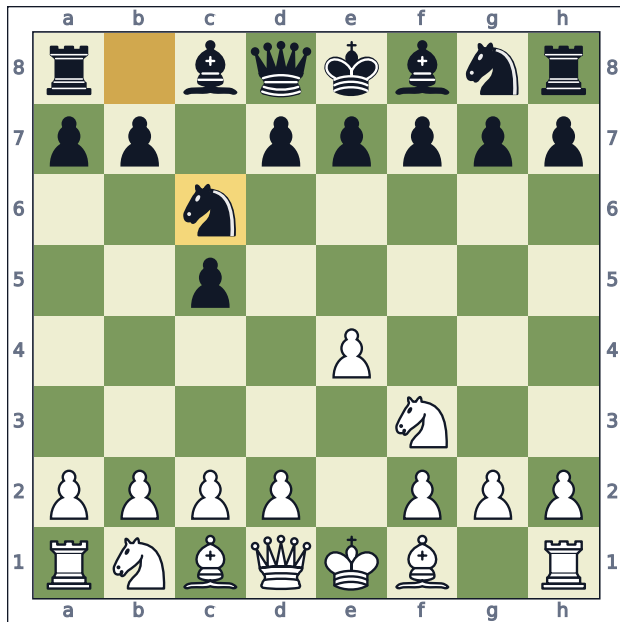
### MEMORY SENTENCE

No ...d6 means ...d5 is always in the room.

## ACTIVE RECALL

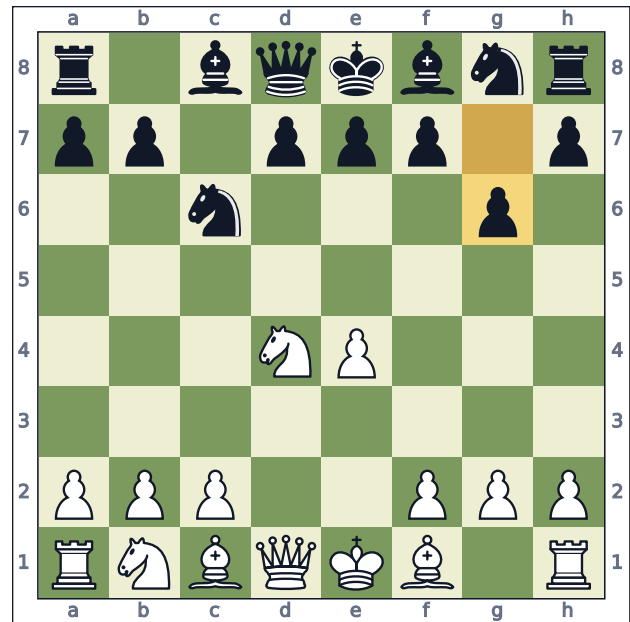
## Recall test: answer before you turn the page

POSITION A



White to move

POSITION B



White to move

- A1. What is the next route move for White?
- A2. What opening problem does that move solve?
- B1. What is the next route move for White?
- B2. Name one plan for White and one plan for Black.
- C. State the thematic pawn break without looking back.

## SCORING

5/5: replay from memory. 3-4/5: review Lessons 3 and 6. 0-2/5: return to Lesson 1 and rebuild the route slowly.

## RETENTION

# Answer key and a 14-day practice loop

**POSITION A**

Next route move: d4. Explain it using development, center, king safety, or a direct tactical need.

**POSITION B**

Next route move: Nc3. Then compare the position with the final core board.

**PLAN AND BREAK ANSWERS**

White: Control d5, consider the Maroczy structure with c4, and avoid routine attacking moves. Black: Use rapid activity, pressure d4, and strike with ...d5 when tactically sound. Lever: ...d5 is the opening's central question; White's c4 can restrain it.

**14-DAY LOOP**

- Days 1-2: replay the first three moves from both sides and name each move's job.
- Days 3-4: build the core position from memory; correct the first error, then restart.
- Days 5-6: say White's plan, Black's plan, and the pawn break without a board.
- Day 7: take the recall test. Record the score; do not count lucky guesses.
- Days 8-10: play three slow practice games, starting from the core position if possible.
- Days 11-13: review only mistakes and deviations that actually occurred in your games.
- Day 14: retake the test and write a one-sentence opening rule in your own words.